

W*D10

The Plain Dealer | Saturday, February 22, 2003

FASTBREAK

High school hoops at a glance.

HOW THEY FARED

Boys

1. St. Vincent-St. Mary (17-1): Idle. Next: Tomorrow vs. Toledo Scott at JAR Arena.
2. Cleveland Heights (16-3): Idle. Next: Friday vs. Shaker Heights.
3. Central-Hoyer (18-1): Idle. Next: Today vs. Lima.
4. Shaw (17-2): Idle. Next: Today vs. No. 11 Warrensville Heights.
5. Olmsted Falls (19-1): Defeated Amherst, 95-90, 3 OT. Next: Friday vs. No. 24 Lakewood/Admiral King in sectional.
6. Stow (18-2): Defeated No. 17 Solon, 79-59. Next: March 1 vs. Cuyahoga Falls/Akron Garfield in sectional.
7. St. Ignatius (14-6): Defeated No. 10 Benedictine, 72-56. Next: Friday vs. John Marshall/Strongsville in sectional.
8. St. Edward (15-5): Defeated Youngstown Chaney, 85-51. Next: March 1 vs. Cloverleaf/N. Ridgeville in sectional.
9. Glenville (14-5): Defeated Youngstown Rayen, 78-56. Next: Today at Warren Harding.
10. Benedictine (16-4): Lost to No. 7 St. Ignatius, 72-56. Next: Friday vs. NDCL at Madison Sectional.
11. Warrensville Heights (15-4): Idle. Next: Today at No. 4 Shaw.
12. Wadsworth (20-0): Defeated Highland, 107-49. Next: Friday vs. Kent Roosevelt/Medina in sectional.
13. Buchtel (15-5): Idle. Next: Wednesday vs. Norton in sectional.
14. Archbishop Hoban (18-1): Defeated Firestone, 56-46. Next: March 1 vs. Firelands or Copley at Barberton Sectional.
15. Mentor (14-6): Defeated Euclid, 70-65. Next: Monday vs. Lakeside at Euclid Sectional.
16. Orange (15-5): Defeated Richmond Heights, 78-65. Next: Wednesday vs. Fairview/Rocky River at Solon Sectional.
17. Solon (15-5): Lost to No. 8 Stow, 79-59. Next: March 1 vs. Berea or Brecksville at Olmsted Falls Sectional.
18. Elyria Catholic (16-4): Defeated Cleveland Central Catholic, 49-48. Next: Friday vs. Wellington at Elyria Sectional.
19. St. Peter Chanel (17-3): Defeated Trinity, 75-36. Next: Friday vs. Berkshire at Lakeland C.C. Sectional.
20. North Royalton (16-4): Defeated Midpark, 58-44. Next: Wednesday vs. Valley Forge at Olmsted Falls Sectional.
21. Elyria (14-6): Defeated No. 24 Lakewood, 59-55. Next: Friday vs. Westlake/Amherst at Midview Sectional.
22. Brush (16-4): Defeated Barberton, 73-45. Next: Tuesday vs. Chardon at Euclid Sectional.
23. Cleveland East (12-4): Idle. Next: Friday vs. East Tech/Warren Howland at Cleveland South Sectional.
24. Lakewood (12-8): Lost to No. 21 Elyria, 59-55. Next: Tuesday vs. Admiral King at Midview Sectional.
25. Collinwood (16-4): Defeated Eastlake North, 59-50. Next: Tuesday vs. Glenville at Euclid Sectional.

Girls

1. Villa Angela-St. Joseph (19-3): Idle. Next: District semifinal vs. Keystone at St. Joseph Academy on Thursday.
2. Regina (18-2): Idle. Next: District semifinal vs. Garretttsville or Hawken at Pymatuning Valley on Thursday.
3. Mentor (20-2): Idle. Next: District semifinal vs. No. 14 Shaw at Perry on Thursday.
4. Padua (18-2): Idle. Next: District semifinal vs. No. 18 Strongsville at Medina on Thursday.
5. Hudson (20-1): Idle. Next: Today vs. Cuyahoga Falls in sectional final at Ellet.
6. Wadsworth (18-3): Idle. Next: District semifinal vs. No. 15 Stow at Ellet on Thursday.
7. Copley (20-2): Idle. Next: District semifinal vs. No. 16 Archbishop Hoban at Rootstown on Thursday.
8. Madison (17-4): Idle. Next: District semifinal vs. No. 9 Eastlake North at Perry on Thursday.
9. Eastlake North (18-4): Idle. Next: District semifinal vs. No. 8 Madison at Perry on Thursday.
10. Barberton (16-5): Idle. Next: Today vs. Green in sectional final at Ellet.
11. East Tech (13-3): Idle. Next: Today vs. Brush in sectional final at Solon.
12. Holy Name (19-3): Idle. Next: District semi vs. Wooster at Medina on Thursday.
13. Walsh Jesuit (16-6): Idle. Next: District semifinal vs. Orange at Brecksville on Thursday.
14. Shaw (19-2): Idle. Next: District semifinal vs. No. 3 Mentor at Perry on Thursday.
15. Stow (15-6): Idle. Next: District semi vs. No. 6 Wadsworth at Ellet on Thursday.
16. Archbishop Hoban (15-6): Idle. Next: District semifinal vs. No. 7 Copley at Rootstown on Thursday.
17. Avon Lake (18-4): Season ended this week with 54-51 triple-overtime loss to Olmsted Falls.
18. Strongsville (18-3): Idle. Next: District semifinal vs. No. 4 Padua at Medina on Thursday.
19. St. Vincent-St. Mary (12-9): Idle. Next: Today vs. Woodridge in sectional final at Smithville.
20. John F. Kennedy (14-3): Idle. Next: Today vs. Solon in sect. final at Solon.
21. Tallmadge (15-6): Idle. Next: District semifinal vs. West Branch at Rootstown on Thursday.
22. Glenville (15-7): Season ended this week with 67-38 loss to No. 14 Shaw.
23. Brooklyn (20-2): Idle. Next: District semifinal vs. Independence at Wellington on Thursday.
24. Twinsburg (15-6): Idle. Next: Today vs. Cleveland Heights in sectional final at Solon.
25. Waterloo (20-0): Idle. Next: Today vs. United in sectional final at United.

HIGH SCHOOL BASKETBALL

BOYS BASKETBALL

Strong second half pulls Pioneers through

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As far as performances go, last night's Lake Erie League win by Elyria, 59-55, over visiting Lakewood won't go down as a classic for either team, but it did allow the Pioneers to leave the league on a winning note.

Elyria, headed for the Pioneer Conference next season, outscored the Rangers, 24-11, in the third quarter to break from an 18-16 deficit at halftime. The Pioneers wrapped up the regular season with a 14-6 record, 8-6 in the LEL Lake Division.

The Rangers completed the regular season at 12-8, 8-6.

After opening a 13-6 lead with 1:40 remaining in the opening period following a 3-pointer by 6-5 senior Dan Gif-

ford, the Rangers went cold.

In the second quarter, they scored only on a 3-pointer by John Dillingham with 3:43 left before halftime and a basket by junior Antonio Kidd with 1:20 remaining.

Meanwhile, the Pioneers battled back with senior Robert Nelson scoring seven points and 6-6 senior Brett Daly hitting a free throw and a basket in the final 40 seconds to cut the Rangers' lead to 18-16.

Elyria began to pull away in the third quarter as Nelson scored seven points and Daly had six to give the Pioneers a 40-29 lead at the end of the period.

Elyria held its biggest lead, 47-29, with 6:42 remaining in the game when

senior Aaron Bally sank two free throws.

Lakewood made a run, outscoring the Pioneers, 26-12, in the final 6:27. Dillingham, a 6-4 senior, led the rally with 12 of his game-high 24 points, which included three 3-pointers.

"The turning point for us came in the final 30 seconds of the first half, when we were trying to hold onto the ball for the final shot," said Lakewood coach Rob Stone. "Instead, they come up with a steal, and Daly scores a basket with four seconds left to cut our lead to two points. If we didn't turn the ball over, we either hit the final shot to go up by seven, or at worst, we miss it, but we've still got a four-point advantage."

"Then, they took charge of the momentum once the second half got under way, and they started to pressure us with their zone matchup. And, we got

frustrated. We completely forgot what got us the lead early on, and we let them dictate the entire third period. By the time we started to turn things around, we'd dug ourselves too deep a hole."

Elyria coach John Srnis agreed.

"Once we turned the pressure up in the third quarter, we caused them to lose their concentration, and they went through periods of indecision," Srnis said. "But, once they got rolling again in the fourth quarter, I think that defensively we got a little too passive, and we really didn't get much of a chance to take advantage of the lead we'd built."

The Pioneers were led by Nelson with 19 points. Daly and junior Greg Bazley scored 11 each.

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C.H. PETE COPELAND / THE PLAIN DEALER

Solon's Reggie Thompson bulls his way toward the hoop as Adam Trent tries to block the way during Stow's 79-59 victory.

Feeling their way

Hot-shooting Bulldogs take home the WRC crown

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Stow's Bulldogs had that feeling last night that every basketball team wants. "It felt like we were making every shot," Stow forward Brian Flaherty said after the Bulldogs shot 63 percent to defeat host Solon, 79-59, in the Western Reserve Conference championship game.

"It felt like we couldn't miss," Flaherty scored 22 points and guard Adam Trent scored 20 as the Bulldogs (18-2) won the WRC Cup for the first time since 1999. The game pitted WRC South Division champion Stow against the North Division champion Comets (15-5).

Stow took control of the game with a remarkable 32-10 run in an eight-minute span of the second and third quarters, giving the Bulldogs a 49-30 lead.

The outburst took just 16 possessions. The first four possessions ended on 3-pointers: two of them by Trent, and one each by Kyle Syx and J.J. McCleary. Will

McGinley contributed two treys to the run and Kendrick Watson canned a 3-pointer and converted a 3-point play.

"We had some good things going," Stow coach Dave Close said. "We like to sub a lot. We kept guys on the floor a little longer, though, because we didn't want to disrupt that run."

The 6-5 Flaherty had already made his impact, scoring 12 points in the first nine minutes. Flaherty finished 10-of-12 from the field. As a testament to the Bulldogs' ball movement, all of Flaherty's baskets were layups. After establishing his inside dominance, Flaherty displayed a nifty passing touch.

Guard-forwards Reggie Thompson and Brandon Innis scored 19 and 12 points, respectively, for Solon, and guard Justin Harris scored 11. The Comets keyed defensively on McGinley, who is averaging 20 points. McGinley, a 6-5 forward,

scored eight points on 2-of-5 shooting but often found teammates in prime shooting spots.

"They were doubling down on Will, following him everywhere," Trent said. "He'd look for the open man and we'd knock down open shots."

Syx held Innis, who has a 17.3-point scoring average, scoreless on three shots until the middle of the third quarter.

"Kyle always guards the best guy on the other team," Close said. "He wants to." Solon has played without standout forward Keenan Underwood (knee injury) since early January.

"Stow has strong kids inside," Comets coach Todd VanReeth said. "That's a tough matchup for us. You give a little help inside and then they shoot the ball very well."

Stow was 9-of-16 on 3-pointers and 20-of-22 at the foul line.

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Balanced Wildcats beat Bengals

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Wildcats held a 10-point lead at halftime.

Continuing to work for high-percentage shots, St. Ignatius moved to a 17-point advantage on a layup by 6-6 senior post Greg Moviel and a 3-pointer and a soft jumper high off the glass by senior guard Terry Walsh.

Benedictine, sparked by the play of guards Vahn Knight and Andre Smith, closed to 40-31 on a 3-pointer by Smith with 3:31 to go in the third quarter.

"Benedictine is a solid basketball team, and Vahn Knight is as good as anybody we've played this year," said St. Ignatius coach Brian Becker after Knight finished with 22 points. "But I thought the difference was our three seniors — Terry Walsh, Greg Moviel and Ryan Stilphen. They are so unselfish and have such a sense of balance and focus."

"They don't care who scores, just as long as we win."

That balance was evident down the stretch as St. Ignatius moved to a

16-point lead on a driving one-hander by the 6-8 Stilphen with 4:13 left. Stilphen scored 11 of his 19 points in the second half. Walsh came up with 17 of his game-high 23 points in the final 16 minutes and Moviel, who finished with a triple-double, produced 12 of his 14 points in the second half. He also had 11 assists and 10 rebounds.

Benedictine made a final run, closing to nine points on baskets by Knight and Sam Jackson with just under three minutes remaining.

St. Ignatius kept its composure, however, and settled the issue on a layup and a soft jumper in the lane by Stilphen, and a three-point play by Walsh.

"We have a nice little run going into the tournament," said Stilphen after he helped the Wildcats to their 10th victory in their last 12 games. "Moving the ball, that's our game. That, and going to the offensive glass."

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ROUNDUP

Amherst takes Falls to 3 OTs

From staff reports

Tying the school record for most regular-season boys basketball victories was anything but easy for Olmsted Falls last night.

Amherst pushed the Bulldogs to three overtimes before falling, 95-90, at Olmsted Falls last night. With the win, Falls (19-1) equaled the regular-season win total by the 1996-97 team; and finished the Southwestern Conference campaign 14-0.

In the third overtime, junior Mickey Mental hit two free throws to seal the victory.

Juniors Jamar Seales and Steve Gansey scored 20 points apiece for Falls. Junior Dan Binggell added 17 points.

For Amherst, Nick Mihalic scored 21 points. Teammate Scott Canter scored 18 and Greg Peltz scored 15 points.

Falls is ranked fifth by The Plain Dealer.

Orange 78, Richmond Hts. 65 Orange, The Plain Dealer's 16th-ranked team, received 24 points from Anthony Byrd and scored a home victory.

The Lions (15-5) also had senior Craig Fuller score 16 points and junior Aaron Turner score 15.

Jim Wochele tossed in 17 points to pace Richmond Heights.

Wadsworth 107, Highland 49 The Grizzlies (20-0) cruised to a Suburban League win at Highland. Nick Goddard led Wadsworth with 26 points. Joe Capotosta added 18 and Ben Falkenberg 16 for the Grizzlies, who finished 14-0 in the Suburban.

St. Peter Chanel 75, Trinity 33 The Firebirds, champions of the North Coast League, rolled to victory in Bedford behind a team-high 20 points from Keith DeV Vaughn. Junior Jarell Brown added 15 points for Chanel. The Firebirds (17-3, 13-1) are ranked 19th by The Plain Dealer.

Elyria Cath. 49, CCC 48 Jason Smith tipped in a missed shot at the buzzer to provide Elyria Catholic with a win at Cleveland Central Catholic.

The Ironmen (12-8) led most of the game before EC closed in. Brandon Rudolph paced CCC with 24 points.

Smith was the high scorer for EC with 20 points. Jake Bailosky added 13 points. EC (16-4) is The Plain Dealer's 18th-ranked team.

Mentor 70, Euclid 65 Euclid's Brandon Mimes and Mentor's Eddie Zienkowski had a scoring duel in a Lake Erie League Lake Division game at Euclid.

Mimes scored 38 for the Panthers. Zienkowski dropped in 30 for the Cardinals, who are ranked 15th by The Plain Dealer. Kyle Binns contributed 13 points for Mentor (14-6, 10-4). Euclid is 3-17, 2-12.

Brush 73, Barberton 45 Junior Steve Carter had 16 points to go with 10 rebounds as the Arcs took care of the Magics in Barberton.

Marcel Frost had 12 points, seven assists, six steals and eight rebounds for Brush, which is ranked 22nd by The Plain Dealer. Elbey Williams, a junior guard, had 12 points for Brush (16-4). Barberton, which dropped to 15-5, fell behind, 25-10, in the first quarter.